

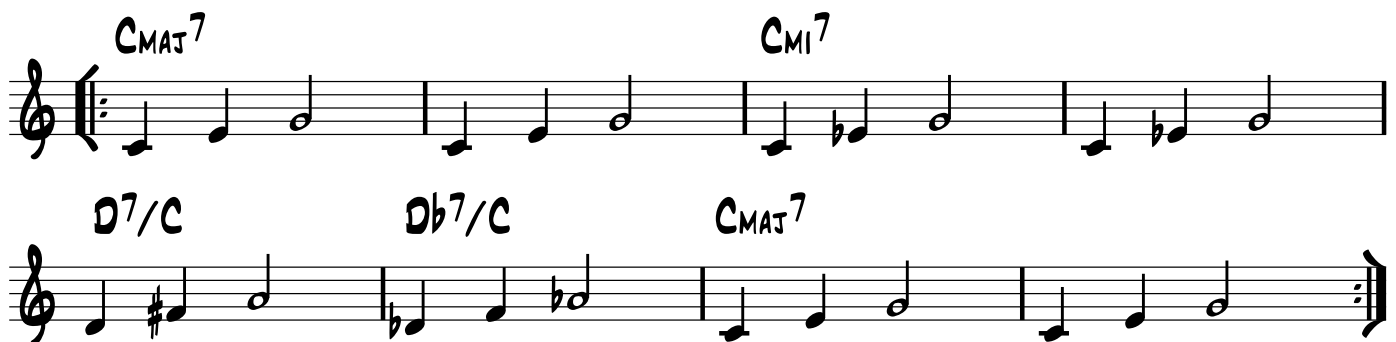
SCALES SUCK!

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #2

Scales are not a terrible thing, but they are also not the best path to getting up and running as an improviser. Unfortunately, many of us have been taught that they are. EVERY pro player has many more tools at their disposal than just scales, and so should you. What is the answer then? A better starting point is to work with CHORD TONES.

Here we are using the first 8 measure of the classic song On Green Dolphin Street as our laboratory. In item #1 below we see just the simple triad notes written out for each chord. In example #2, we see those same triad notes, with the inclusion of a lower neighbor tone for each. Literally, the chord tone, and a half step below. Let the music flow!

#1 - Triads



#2 - Triads with lower neighbors

